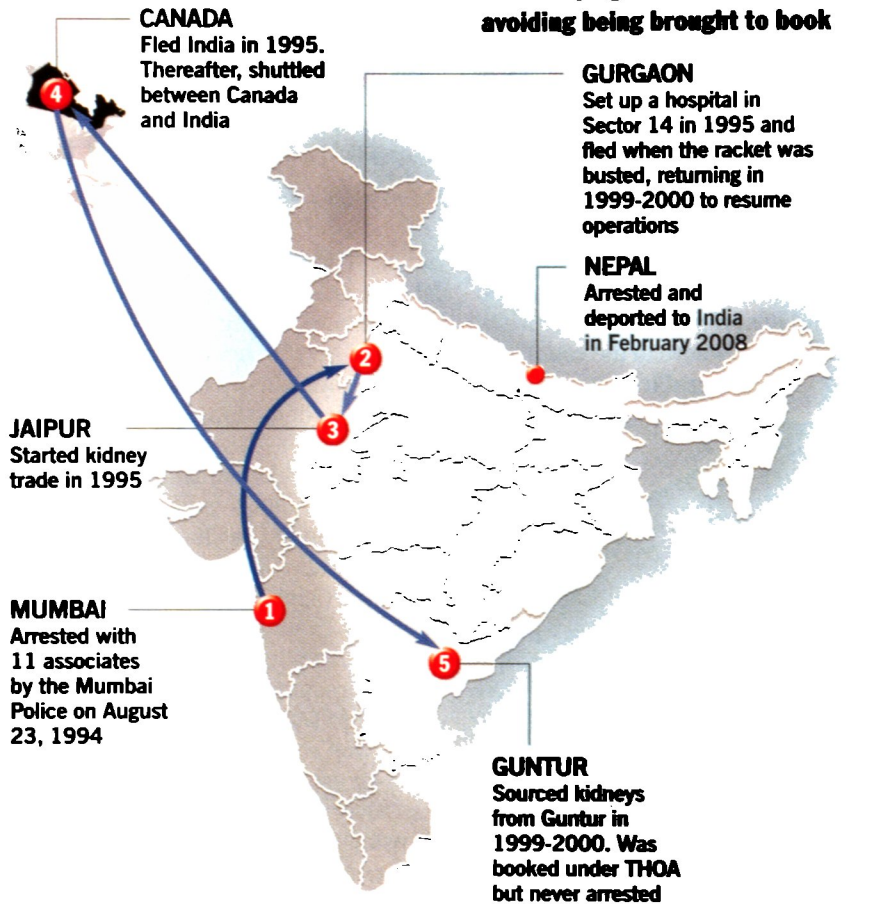


A TRAIL OF DECEIT



Map & distance not to scale

government may create laws (the Transplantation of Human Organs Act, or THOA, 1994, in this case), but health being a state subject, states are not required to abide by them. Kumar cashed in on this. If the police got a whiff of the racket, he would simply move to another state, where the laws were not enforced as strictly. After his arrest in 1994, Kumar was remanded to judicial custody in Mumbai's Arthur Road prison, where he stayed for five months until he was bailed out in 1995. The doctor then set up a hospital in Gurgaon, Haryana.

Over time, Kumar grew cautious, shifting base frequently. After a raid at his hospital in Gurgaon in 1995, he fled, reportedly setting up shop in Jaipur. However, his trade could not flourish there as his premises were raided after reports that he had extracted the kidney of a rickshaw-puller. He kept appearing in court till 1996, after which he suddenly stopped attending the hearings and disappeared. According to police reports, he then fled to Canada. Around 1999-2000, the doctor returned to India and set up shop again, sourcing kidneys from Guntur—where he was booked under THOA but never arrested—and conducting operations in Gurgaon.

In December 2000, he was arrested by the Delhi Police in Nizamuddin and in 2001, a Mumbai Police team caught him. He was also booked by the Enforcement Directorate under the Conservation of Foreign Exchange and Prevention of Smuggling Activities Act for possessing thousands of dollars. He was sent to Pune's Yerwada Jail and was bailed out again, after which he regularly attended court cases. In 2003, when the Mumbai Police registered a case against him for forcibly extracting kidneys, Kumar again fled to Canada. All this while, the peripatetic doctor continued his racket, even financing a B-grade movie, *Bombay To Goa*, starring TV's *The Great Indian Laughter Challenge* stand-up comedians.

It comes as a major embarrass-

THE NETWORK: (Clockwise from bottom left) Dr Upendra Aggarwal; anaesthesiologist Dr Krishna Kumar Agarwal, arrested in Moradabad; Dr Saraj, who surrendered in Gurgaon

